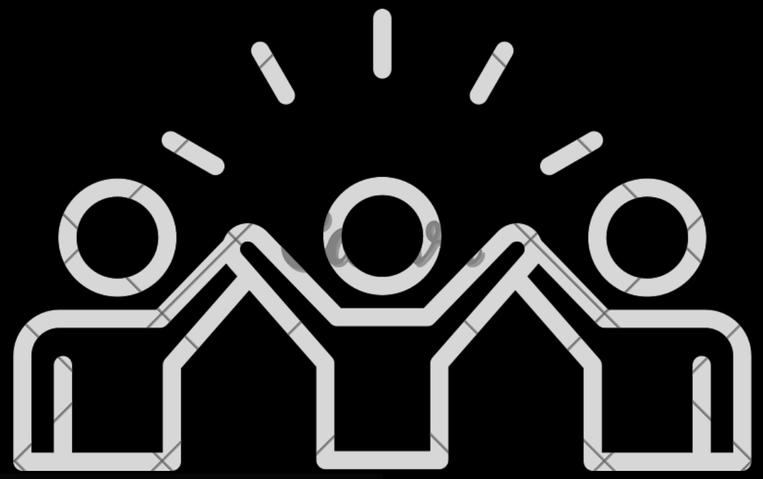
Motivation & Change at Ecomm Edge



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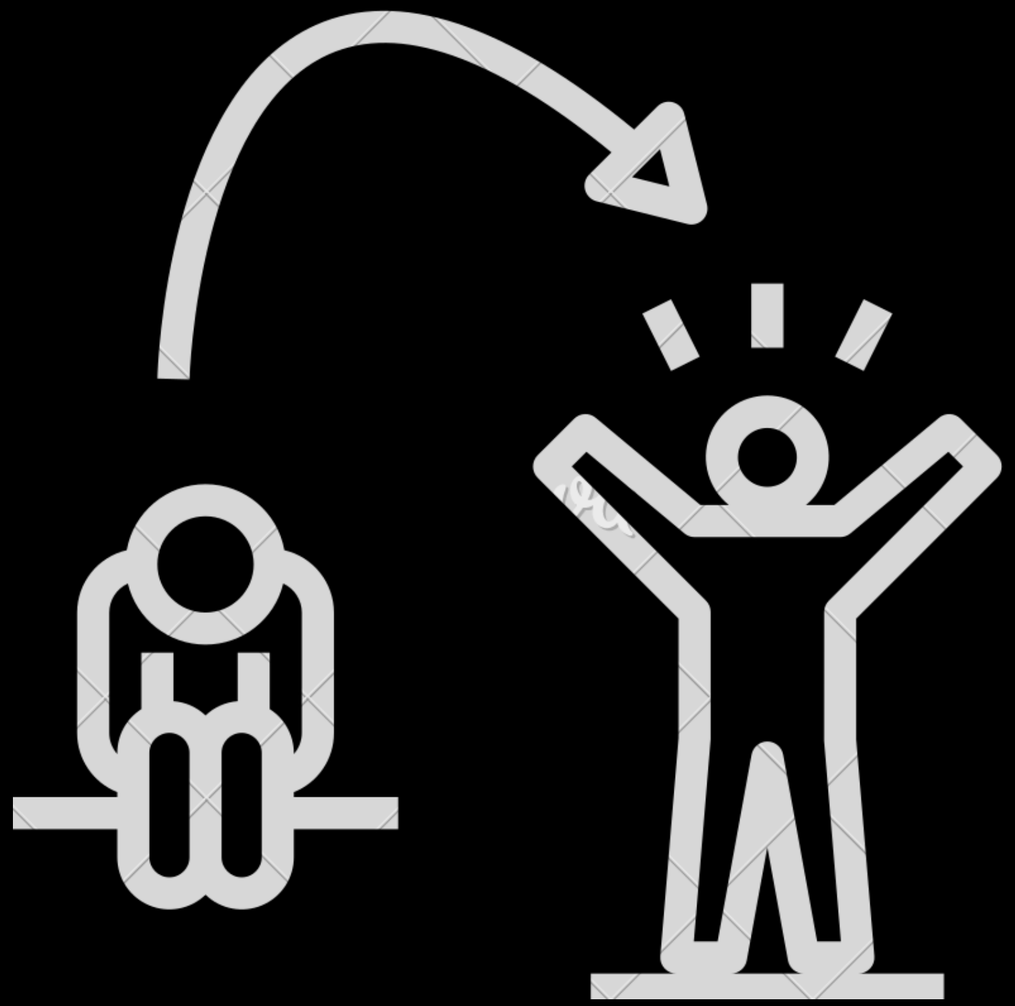


Executive Introduction

About Ecomm Edge

Ecom Edge is India’s premier D2C e-commerce accelerator, designed to empower 10,000+ entrepreneurs to build and scale lean brands. Led by active practitioners Nishkarsh Sharma and Ishan Suri, who have driven over ₹80 Crores in combined sales, the platform serves as a 360-degree "university" for digital retail. By combining proprietary frameworks like "The Zuck Method" with data-driven product research and weekly mentorship, Ecom Edge provides the tactical advantage needed to turn aspiring entrepreneurs into profitable, high-growth businessmen.

Strategic Approach & Vision

- 360-Degree Ecosystem: Unlike standard courses, Ecom Edge operates as a D2C University, offering a complete ecosystem that covers mindset, strategy, and execution.
- Lean Business Model: Focuses on building sustainable, bootstrapped brands with high exit potential, rather than just short-term cash flow.
- Global to Local: specialised in adapting international e-commerce strategies (scaling systems used globally) for the unique challenges of the Indian market.

Problem Definition

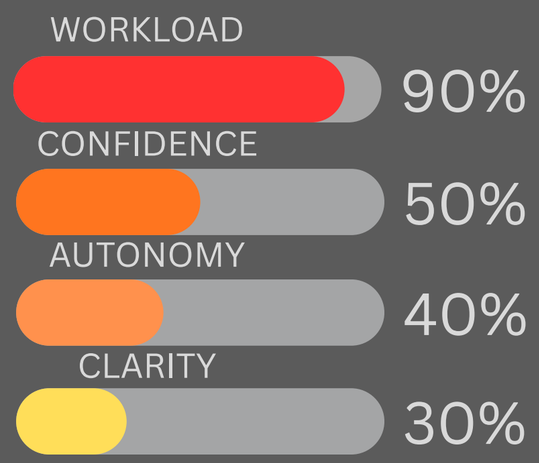
Performance indicators and employee sentiment insights

To determine the main problems affecting Ecomm Edge, we took three steps: first we spoke with the co-founder; second we used a questionnaire sent to the sales team; third, we looked at performance data in Excel to see how the organisation had changed and the impact on motivation and performance for their sales team.

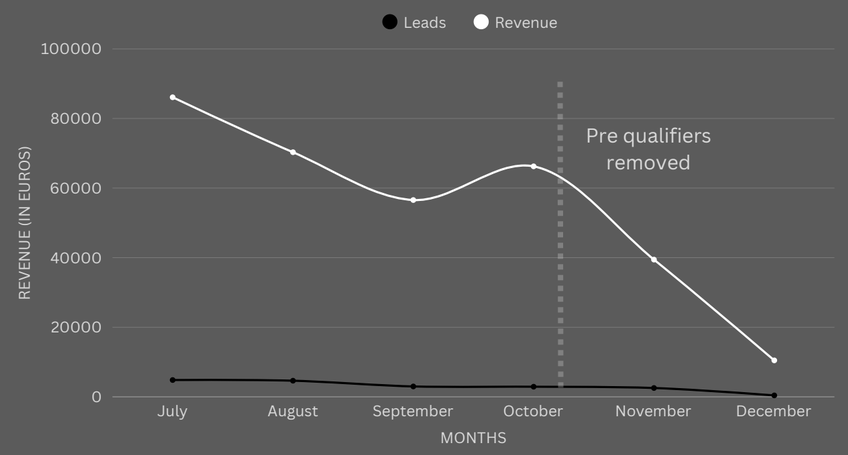
Leadership Perspective

- Improved Closer Performance: New closers outperform previous ones, even without support from pre-qualifiers.
- Scalability Risk: The full-funnel model's long-term scalability is unproven, with potential bottlenecks if closers struggle to balance qualification and closing.

Evidence from Sales Team Feedback and Performance Data



EMPLOYEE WELLBEING DASHBOARD



MONTHLY LEADS AND REVENUE PERFORMANCE

Both leads and revenue follow a consistent pattern until a sudden decline in November. The timing matches the organisational change, indicating that removing pre-qualifiers directly affected call quality, conversions and overall performance.

Diagnostic Analysis of Underlying Causes

Organisational culture and change dynamics

What Research Says About Change Resistance

Salesperson resistance to change: an empirical investigation of antecedents and outcomes

Workload Drives Resistance: The strongest predictor of resistance is the perceived increase in workload.

Occupational stress, burnout, and change fatigue as predictors of quiet quitting among teachers

Organisational change can trigger change fatigue when it is poorly communicated, increases workload, reduces role clarity, and removes a sense of stability.

Scaling-up: Building, Leading and Sustaining Rapid Growth Over Time

Three Pillars of Scaling: Expansion (more customers), Replication (spread best practices), Synchronisation (coordination) must work together; if any fail, scaling fails.

What This Means for Ecomm Edge

Heavy Workload = Closer Resistance: A new lead filtering process creates an increased workload.

Reduced Autonomy: Closers feel a lack of independence in their ability to complete their work.

Eliminating the filter system created significant changes in process without any type of consulting or preparation.

These changes created an excellent climate for "quiet quitting”.

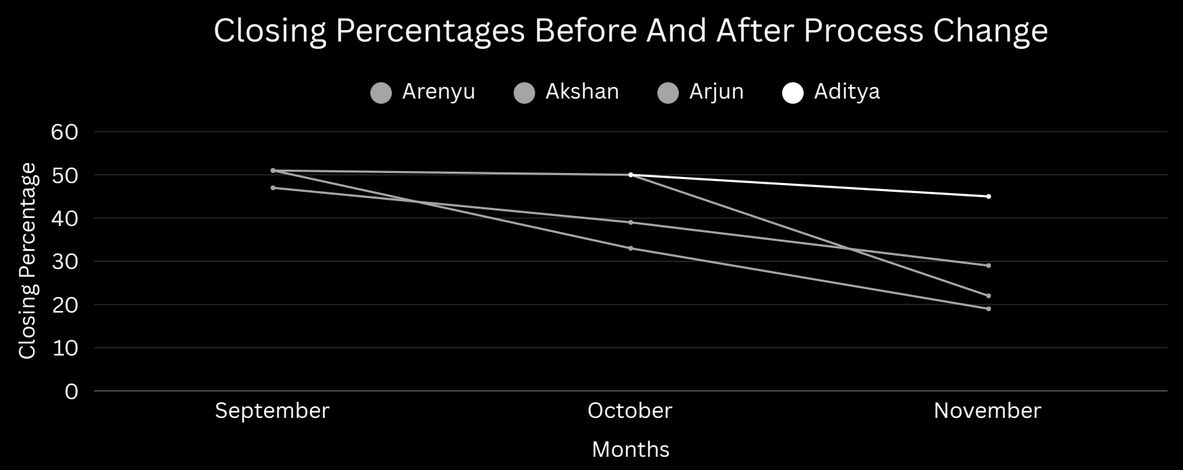
The elimination of pre-sales personnel resulted in inconsistencies and knowledge scattering.

Disrupted Synchronisation by combining processes causing inefficiencies.

Organisational Change: Employee Performance Insights

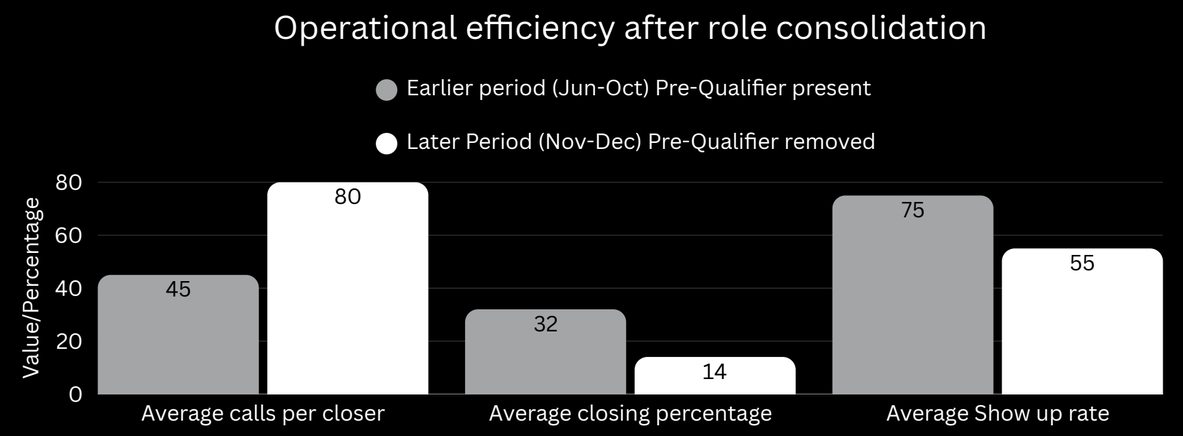
Performance Impact on New and Old Closers

Closers' feedback hints at a workload increase and a reduction in confidence and clarity in their approach.
These impacts most affected the older closers as they saw a significant drop in closing percentages as opposed to the newer closer (Aditya), who remained the top performer in the months when the change was implemented.



Organisational Change and Operational Efficiency

The role consolidation led to a shift in workflows and responsibilities.
While expectations increased, teams required additional time, clarity, and alignment to adapt effectively.
This indicates an efficiency gap commonly observed during periods of organisational change.



Motivation and workload dynamics

What Research Says About Employee Motivation & Disengagement

The Role of Change Readiness and Colleague Support in the Role Stressors and Withdrawal Behaviours Relationship among Health Care Employees

When organizations add demands without support, employees protect themselves through quiet quitting – present physically, but disengaged mentally.

The Role of Organisational Support in Improving Employees Performance

Three Critical Questions: Is this just? Does leadership support me? Do I have a say?
When answers are NO, organisational commitment fails.

Work Engagement: A Meta-Analysis Using the Job Demands-Resources Model

High demands without support, tools, or clarity lead to burnout.
Demands up, resources down, which leads to motivation and commitment collapsing

What This Means for Ecomm Edge

Due to Ecom Edge eliminating the lead-filtering function, the workload and stress of the sales team increased, which ultimately contributed to employee burnout and disengagement.

Employees are now doing less than before and are producing lower results than expected; however, their performance expectations remained the same..

Fairness Perception: Workload increased (screening added), but compensation stayed the same. Employees also feel they're doing pre-sales work at closer salary.

Lack of Participation: Change was imposed without employee consultation or co-creation, leaving employees feeling powerless. Hence, employees' motivation dropped.

The Before-After Shift at Ecom Edge:
Before: Closers had LOW demands (closing only) and HIGH resources (autonomy, clarity, valued expertise)

After: Closers face HIGH demands (screening + closing = 3x workload) and LOW resources (no training, no tools, no support, lost autonomy)

Motivation Theory On Employee and Performance Data

Work Design Flow

Role Expansion

↓

Higher Job Demands

↓

Reduced Support and Resources

↓

Lower Focus and Energy

↓

Reduced Sales Effectiveness

Strategic Insights

This indicates the issue lies in system design, not employee capability

Without rebalancing demands and resources, performance decline is likely to continue.

This reduced call focus and increased fatigue, lowering closing effectiveness.

Removing pre-qualifiers increased workload without adequate support, degrading call quality and conversions, triggering burnout, and transforming a scalability-driven change into a decline in performance, autonomy, and confidence.

Strategic Recommendations

Motivation through Tech Efficiency and Visible Leadership

Lead cycle

Leads come in

↓

Chatbot/AI Prequalifiers

↓

Qualified? yes/no

↓

Student Success Manageer

The Tech Fix

Automated conversational qualification tool, either a WhatsApp chatbot or an AI prequalification

Improves the lead life cycle and ensures less friction

Reduces the Average Response Time (ART) and also ensures a higher show-up rate.

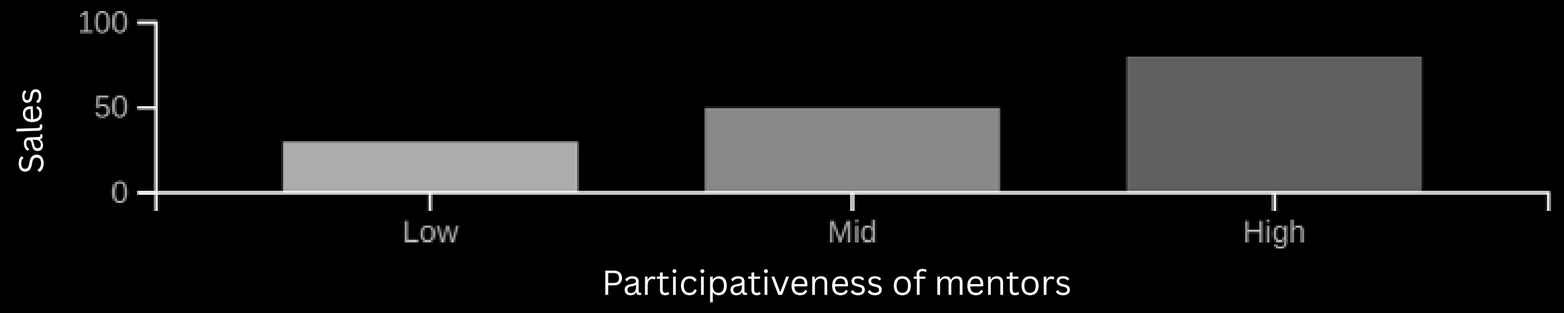
Visible leadership

Leadership presence correlates with sales performance

Restored visibility of key leaders (Mentors, Nishkarsh)

Builds trust, improves communication

Enhances employee engagement and motivation



Anchoring Change in an Expert Culture

Leverage Autonomy

Respects sales reps' expertise in their field

Removes time-consuming obstacles like lead filtering

Empowers reps to focus on high-value selling activities

Best practices in change management

Standardise Toolkit

Develop a "Living Playbook" for dynamic resource

Centralizes protocols, updated scripts, best practices

Provides standardized toolkit for new procedures

Research on sales playbooks

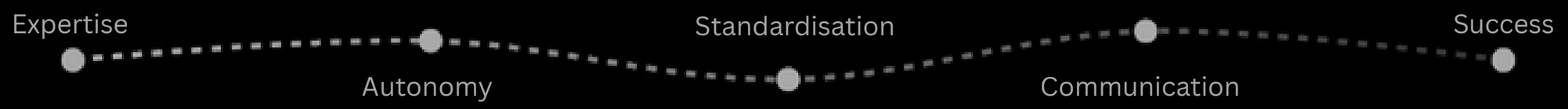
The "Why" Communication

Transparent and logical communication for experts

Articulates strategic rationale behind tech adoption

Emphasises increasing high-quality sales opportunities

Crucial for buy-in during change



Implementation Roadmap: Lean efficiency Model

Weeks 1-3

Phase 1: Tech Deployment

Building and Testing WhatsApp/Logic Bot

Configuring Automated CRM Workflows

Technical integration of new systems

Technical foundation

Week 4

Phase 2: Leadership Re-Engagement

"All-Hands" Meeting to communicate strategic "why"

Key leaders return to sales floor

Visible presence provides direct support

People-focused shift

Week 5+

Phase 3: Zero-Friction Launch

Full Rollout of Auto-Filtering System

Continuous Feedback Loop for Sales Reps

Iterative improvements based on feedback

Continuous optimization

Thank You

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